



AI in EHS, 2026–27

Seminars, Students, and a Spring Conference

— *bringing people together through creative thinking* —

A WORKING VISION · TODD EDWARDS · 2026-05-16

Shared with Sherrill Sellers, Amity Noltemeyer, and Nazan Bautista

Executive summary

Across EHS, AI integration is already underway — EDP’s new Inclusive Education Program, SLAM’s Introduce/Practice/Demonstrate progression across 575 majors, TCE’s coursework around LessonBuddy and ToddGPT, and the AYA-Math program’s revised outcomes. What’s missing is a **coordination layer** that ties this work together, reaches every department, and brings the rest of Miami into the conversation. The plan below proposes three coordinated layers for academic year 2026–27: a **six-session faculty seminar series** running through the EHS Tech Committee; a **CREATE Lab** — a student arm housed in the underutilized Engaging Technology Lab — that gives Spring 2027 CSE/TCE-bridge-course students a home, a name, and a role; and a **Spring 2027 EHS-AI Conference** that builds on the 2025 CREATE AI Mini-Conference Sherrill and Todd ran together. None of this requires new infrastructure; all of it activates assets EHS already owns. The goal is to make AI work in EHS *legible* — to ourselves, to the rest of Miami, and to the funders whose interest is now turning toward exactly this kind of cross-disciplinary, pedagogy-first work.

The opportunity

Three things are happening at the same time, and they don’t usually all happen at once:

- **EHS has just finalized its Strategic Framework** (April 2026, with Rice Education Consulting). Four pillars — People/Culture, Student Experience, Research/Innovation/Partnerships, Stewardship — give every initiative a shared vocabulary for the first time in years.
- **AI work inside EHS is mature, not nascent.** Multiple departments have detailed integration plans, named teams, and Fall 2026 launch dates. The May 7 end-of-year deck made this visible across the college.
- **The wider Miami environment is converging.** David Seidl’s Nebula One initiative is naming an AI Center director through THRIVE; the university’s AI Symposium ran its third year in April; Alkimi AI (founded by professors, classroom-piloted at Miami) is ready for a Fall pilot in EHS.

The work below sits at that intersection. It is what a faculty member running this work would propose if they were already running it — because, in the form of CREATE AI 2025, the present coursework, and the Tech Committee’s Spring 2026 planning, parts of it already are.

One calibration up front. The December 2025 Tech Committee conversation explicitly named AI fatigue — “*AI is becoming overkill. Gotta mix it up.*” That calibration shapes this proposal. The frame is **emergent technology**, not AI-specifically: AI is the most active of the emergent tools right now, but the seminars, the lab, and the conference are designed for the wider category. Wearables, VR (already on the Spring 2026 Brown Bag calendar via FSW), data visualization, video production — these are the tools faculty will care about as much as language models. The proposal centers practice, not platform.

The plan: three coordinated layers

Layer 1 — Monthly faculty seminar series (the anchors)

Three seminars per semester; six total in 2026–27. Each session is anchored to one EHS department (themes below) and paired with a guest department from a different Miami college. The seminars run through the **EHS Tech Committee**, which has dormant capacity Todd chairs and a representative from every department.

Format per session (90 minutes): outside speaker (30 min) → moderated discussion (30 min) → hands-on / breakout (30 min). The hands-on block is where committee reps form pairs with guest-department faculty for the carry-back.

The seminars are launching points, not events. Each session seeds a month of follow-on activity that the Tech Committee carries forward:

- **An intra-departmental conversation** in the weeks after, led by the committee rep from each EHS department — the seminar’s content meets each department’s specific work.
- **A Brown Bag** the following month — informal, lunchtime, a faculty member who tried something inspired by the seminar demonstrates what worked (and what didn’t). The Tech Committee already has Brown Bags in motion for Spring 2026 (Feb FSW/VR; March Teacher-in-a-Can Assessment Bots).
- **A microgrant cycle** — small (\$200–\$600) competitive awards for faculty or students who want to try a tool or workflow they saw at the seminar. Low-friction, fast turnaround, accountable to a one-page writeup.
- **An entry in the EHS AI Teaching Toolkit** — a curated, discipline-specific collection of assignments, prompts, and implementation guidance. The seminar’s speaker contributes; the CREATE Lab students help format and disseminate.
- **A 3-minute video podcast episode** — short, punchy, one faculty member showing one thing they tried. Building on the format Todd’s already piloted (the 3-minute Todd-in-a-Can talk that landed well with EHS leadership earlier this week). The series doubles as the seminar’s takeaway artifact and as a recruiting tool for the following month’s Brown Bag. *Episodes 1 and 2 are embedded below as live examples.*
- **An optional newsletter writeup** — text overview that links the episodes for people who scan rather than watch.
- **Material for the Classroom Showcase** sent up to the Dean’s office — visible record of work happening in EHS classrooms.

What this looks like working: a seminar on Assessment with AI in October launches a November Brown Bag where someone shows the Teacher-in-a-Can assessment-bot pattern from Todd’s TCE 318P, three faculty apply for microgrants to try it in their own courses, and two of those faculty contribute toolkit entries by December that the February Brown Bag features. Each seminar generates roughly a semester of downstream activity.

Layer 2 — CREATE Lab (student arm)

Spring 2027 will see the first offering of the cross-listed **CSE/TCE bridge course** Todd developed with Daniela Inclezan and Naz Bautista. That cohort gets a home: **CREATE Lab**, housed in the currently underutilized **Engaging Technology Lab (ETL)**. The Tech

Committee already discussed the ETL configuration in December 2025 and converged on a plan that maps cleanly onto CREATE Lab’s needs:

- The **large room** becomes a high-touch instructional space available to faculty teaching with technology.
- The **second room** returns to a faculty checkout space for equipment and materials (student checkout was removed due to service cost).
- Across the lab, the original concept of an **experimental space for faculty** is restored — a place where the EHS technology cohort takes risks together.

CREATE Lab activates that vision by adding a

student

layer the December plan invited but didn’t yet name. The structure has two tiers:

Ambassadors — students from Todd’s Spring 2027 CSE/TCE bridge course form the leadership tier. Their structured assignments map directly onto the Tech Committee’s December initiative list:

- The **Monthly Tech Observations + Writeups** (one classroom visit per month, newsletter-ready writeup) become ambassador coursework — they do the observing and the writing.
- The **dissemination assets** (short videos, demo screencasts, lesson-plan kits) become ambassador deliverables, doubling as the broader-impacts evidence grant proposals request.
- Organizing the **Spring 2027 EHS-AI Conference** is the year’s capstone for the ambassador cohort.

Members — any EHS or Miami student is welcome to join, no required role, no prerequisite. The ambassadors run the room; the membership keeps the room full. Exactly the December framing: *“It shouldn’t be limited to faculty. Faculty members may have a project they would like to involve students with.”*

Todd serves as faculty advisor. The students do the work; the lab gives them a place to do it.

*(Working name: **CREATE Lab**, tying into the existing CREATE AI brand from 2025. Final name TBD with the inaugural ambassador cohort — letting them name the thing they inherit is part of how it becomes theirs.)*

Regional campuses are not an afterthought

EHS at the Regionals (Hamilton, Middletown) is structurally underweighted in most Oxford-anchored initiatives. This plan treats Regional engagement as load-bearing, not optional:

- **Tony Rose** (Miami Hamilton, started the cybersecurity program there) is a named speaker for the FERPA + Cybersecurity seminar.
- **Aaditya Paudel** (Miami Middletown, AthenaV6 / local-LLM work, named by David Seidl as “a colleague on the Regionals”) is a collaborator across the FERPA, Cross Curricular, and Research- with-AI sessions, and a likely contributor on the AYA-Alkimi pilot data.
- All seminars run **hybrid** (Zoom + in-person), as the Tech Committee already does — Regional faculty join in real time, not in recordings.
- **CREATE Lab membership and ambassador roles** are open to Regional students through hybrid participation, with at least one in-person session per semester hosted at a Regional campus.
- The **Spring 2027 EHS-AI Conference** includes a Regional spotlight — a session led by Regional faculty on what Oxford-anchored framings miss about teaching at a non-flagship campus.

Layer 3 — Spring 2027 EHS-AI Conference

A direct extension of **CREATE AI 2025** (“Critical Reasoning & Equity through AI Tools and Engagement”), the half-day conference Todd and Sherrill organized April 25, 2025 at McGuffey Hall — keynotes by Mandy Olejnik and Glenn Platt, 20+ presenters, cross-departmental EHS participation already established.

The 2027 iteration scales that work into an annual EHS tradition, explicitly differentiated from the university-wide Miami AI Symposium (IT-Services-led, two-day, generalist):

MIAMI AI SYMPOSIUM	EHS-AI CONFERENCE (PROPOSED)
University-wide, IT-Services-hosted	EHS-hosted, faculty- and student-led
Generalist (governance, creative arts, innovation)	Discipline-specific (teaching, social work, sport, kinesiology, leadership)
Top-down: vendor demos, institutional posture	Bottom-up: classroom practice, lived experience
April	Earlier in spring — complements, does not compete

The university symposium asks “*what is AI doing to the institution?*” The EHS-AI Conference asks “*what does AI mean for teaching practice and the people we prepare to teach?*” Different question, same arc.

The six seminars: themes, EHS anchors, cross-college partners

Each session anchors to one EHS department (where the theme has the sharpest fit) and pairs with a Miami department or unit from outside EHS. Names below are starting points — final speakers and partners will be confirmed across summer planning.

#	THEME	EHS ANCHOR	CROSS-COLLEGE PARTNER	POSSIBLE SPEAKERS
1	Assessment with AI	EDP — measurement and assessment is the department's core	Howe Center for Writing Excellence (writing assessment + AI-informed writing pedagogy)	Mandy Olejnik (Howe / AI-Informed Writing Pedagogy); EDP IEP team
2	Building Apps	TCE — teachers as builders, vibe coding, ToddGPT / LessonBuddy as live examples	Computer Science (CAS) + Alkimi AI	TCE faculty; CS partner; Alkimi team (Todd Wigger / Dillon Uzar) demonstrating faculty-built curriculum-grounded agents
3	FERPA + Cybersecurity	EDL — administrators carry the data-governance responsibility	CSE (College of Engineering and Computing)	David Seidl (CIO, Nebula One); Eli Cochran (Tri-Rivers cybersecurity); Tony Rose (Miami Hamilton cybersecurity program)
4	Research with AI	FSSW — qualitative coding, IRB-sensitive populations, the	University Libraries + Anthropology (CAS)	OJSM citation-validator demonstration; library partners on AI in

#	THEME	EHS ANCHOR	CROSS-COLLEGE PARTNER	POSSIBLE SPEAKERS
		Frankenstein-citations work		literature review
5	AI for Practice & Performance Data	KNH — wearables, biometrics, motion capture, exercise/ nutrition data	Statistics (CAS) + Miami Athletics	Invited hockey, football, basketball coaches and trainers; KNH faculty currently working with performance data
6	Cross Curricular with AI	SLAM — sports analytics as the cleanest example of AI moving across disciplines	Farmer School of Business + Miami Polytechnic / Butler Tech	Adam Beissel / Ryan Chen (SLAM); Business-school partner; PolyTech leadership and Butler Tech faculty on workforce-applied AI + advanced manufacturing (the AM Hub story is the natural cross-pollination exemplar)

Session #5 is the one the conference circuit hasn't seen before: Miami Athletics in the same room as EHS faculty, talking about the same data. That's a story.

Alignment with the EHS Strategic Framework

Every layer of this plan maps to the four pillars EHS just finalized:

- **Pillar 1 — People, Culture, and Shared Purpose.** The Tech Committee reactivates as a working body with a shared agenda. Faculty across departments meet each other, not just their own chair.
 - **Pillar 2 — Student Experience, Success, and Outcomes.** CREATE Lab is a named student space. The Fall 2026 Alkimi pilot gives AYA-Math students a hands-on AI experience that no other Miami program currently offers their students.
 - **Pillar 3 — Research, Innovation, and Partnerships.** Every seminar pairs an EHS department with a non-EHS Miami unit. By the end of the year, EHS has six new working relationships with the rest of Miami, plus documented engagement with the OMSC network (Cochran, Foley, Silbernagel) and ODHE-adjacent partners.
 - **Pillar 4 — Stewardship and Sustainability.** The whole plan activates existing assets: an existing committee, an underutilized lab space, an existing co-organizer relationship (Sherrill), an existing conference brand (CREATE AI), and existing classroom AI work. There's no proposed new line item.
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External funding alignment

The seminars, the CREATE Lab, and the AYA-Alkimi pilot generate exactly the artifacts that competitive grants ask for: attendance records, pre/post AI-literacy assessments, documented cross-college collaborations, classroom-implementation evidence, and dissemination-ready recordings. By the end of academic year 2026–27, EHS has the pilot data and partner network that turns isolated faculty work into a fundable portfolio.

A specific near-term opportunity: Naz and Todd pursue a small external grant to **underwrite the Fall 2026 AYA-Math Alkimi pilot**. The ask is modest (covering Alkimi licenses for roughly one cohort); the deliverable list is concrete (the pilot itself plus the documentation it produces); and the funder story writes itself — *EHS pilots a Miami-built, faculty-controlled AI platform in a teacher-preparation program, with local-LLM infrastructure as the comparison case*. Naz's grants/partnerships role makes her the natural lead; Todd contributes the academic content and the pilot cohort. If the grant lands, it pays for itself many times over in follow-on proposals.

Longer-arc grant pathways the broader work feeds:

FUNDER / PROGRAM	WHY THIS WORK FITS
NSF DUE / IUSE	The AYA-Alkimi pilot is a textbook IUSE Level 1 design
NSF EDU Core Research	Faculty AI-integration practices across disciplines
NVIDIA Academic Hardware Grant	Aligns directly with Seidl’s Nebula One direction
Ohio Department of Higher Education AI initiatives	Via OMSC / Tom Sudkamp connections through Greg Foley
Spencer Foundation	Teacher-preparation focus matches TCE + EDP IEP

The grant-readiness layer is the part of this work most often invisible from outside, and the part that most directly serves Pillar 4 and the college’s external-funding ambitions.

What's next

Concrete moves, building on Tech Committee work already underway:

1. **Carry forward the Tech Committee's Spring 2026 momentum.** The December 2025 brainstorm identified the initiatives this proposal organizes; the January 2026 agenda already prioritized them. Nicole Carr volunteered to help with January planning; Sherrill and Todd have been meeting on items. This isn't a new committee — it's the same committee with a clearer year-long arc.
2. **Lock in the ETL configuration** per the December 2025 plan: classroom + faculty checkout + experimental space, with CREATE Lab's student-ambassador layer added.
3. **Submit the Faculty Learning Community (FLC) proposal** Todd committed to writing at the December meeting — this is a clean funding-and-recognition vehicle for the seminar series' participating faculty.
4. **Outline the small external grant proposal** for the Alkimi pilot — Naz to lead funder identification; Todd to draft the academic content; June–July work.
5. **Confirm Fall 2026 Alkimi pricing and roster** with Alkimi's team (Todd Wigger contact).
6. **Identify session 1 outside speaker** (Assessment with AI) and the cross-college partner; **Armstrong Institute funds are already available for speaker honoraria** per the December conversation. Pilot the format with this session before locking the rest.
7. **Begin Spring 2027 conference planning** — re-engage the CREATE AI 2025 organizing relationships (Mandy Olejnik, Sherrill, the prior presenter list across Howe, FSW, ENG, KNH, Advancement).
8. **Operationalize Tech Microgrants** (\$200–\$600 competitive awards per the December plan) as the small-stakes funding mechanism that catches faculty momentum between seminars.

This list is what a year of EHS-AI coordination looks like once it moves from idea to artifact — and most of these items have a Tech-Committee paper trail to point at, not a wish.

Working roster

The people whose involvement this plan assumes (or invites):

- **Internal EHS:** Sherrill Sellers, Amity Noltemeyer, Naz Bautista, Brian Schultz, Darrel Davis (EDP), Melissa Chase (SLAM), Adam Beissel (SLAM), Ryan Chen (SLAM), Scott Sander (TCE), Matthew Siegel (TCE), the EHS Tech Committee reps from each department.
- **Cross-college Miami:** David Seidl (CIO), Mandy Olejnik (Howe / AI-Informed Writing Pedagogy), Daniela Inclezan (CSE), Tony Rose (Miami Hamilton), Heidi McKee (Provost AI Fellow).
- **Beyond Miami:** Eli Cochran (Tri-Rivers), Greg Foley (Ohio University, OMSC), the Alkimi AI team (Todd Wigger, Dillon Uzar), Butler Tech leadership and the AM Hub partnership network.
- **Miami Regionals partners:** Aaditya Paudel (Middletown, AthenaV6 collaborator), Tony Rose (Hamilton, cybersecurity program), Miami Polytechnic leadership.

This vision is polished but tentative — a starting point. Every piece welcomes redirection from Sherrill, Amity, Naz, and the departments themselves. The job of the next few weeks is to find out where this is right, where it's wrong, and what the people who live in each EHS department actually need from a year like this.